

WAVE OF PROTEST
Manoj Jarange-Patil leads a demonstration for Maratha quotas in Mumbai, Jan. 27

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AND ON CASTE QUOTAS

INDIA

TDP: TDP chief N. Chandrababu Naidu has stressed that the party has actively fought for Muslim reservations in Andhra Pradesh, asserting that it is the party's obligation to fulfil its promises. "We will preserve the 4 per cent reservation for Muslims and provide Rs 5,000 a month in financial aid for mosque maintenance," he said

NCP (AP): In their party manifesto, the Ajit Pawar-led NCP lent its full support to the demand for a caste-based census

CONGRESS: The party has in its manifesto, announced it will conduct a nationwide socioeconomic and caste census to enumerate the castes and sub-castes and assess their present condition. Based on the data, they will strengthen the agenda for affirmative action

- The Congress guarantees that it will pass a constitutional amendment to raise the 50 per cent cap on reservations for SCs, STs and OBCs
- The party promises to implement 10 per cent quota in jobs and educational institutions for the EWS communities without discrimination

NCP (SP): In its party manifesto, the Sharad Pawar faction says it favours a caste census. "We will push for a constitutional amendment to increase the reservation cap beyond 50 per cent," said Maharashtra unit chief Jayant Patil

RJD: Party supremo Lalu Prasad has advocated reservation not based on religion but on social backwardness. "In the Mandal Commission report, more than 3,500 BCs are listed who are entitled to reservations, including hundreds of castes of other religions," he says

SP: It has all along maintained that the share of a caste group in reservation and government schemes should be proportionate to its share in the population

- It favours increasing the 27 per cent reservation cap for the OBCs, stating they are over 60 per cent in Uttar Pradesh

TMC: West Bengal CM and Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee has maintained silence about the caste census and reservation; the party manifesto does not comment on reservation either

- On May 22, Mamata reacted sharply to the Calcutta High Court's annulment of old executive orders and a law that had included 106 Muslim groups among OBCs, saying, "I do not accept a judgment that says Muslims should be kept out of OBC reservation.... This is a tainted chapter in the country."